

Board of Trustees Meeting Minutes
Wednesday, November 19, 2025
5:30 p.m. via Zoom

Administrative Service Center
415 Tumwater Blvd SW
Tumwater, WA 98501

Toni Gwin, *President, Pacific County*
Brian Mittge, *President Elect, Lewis County*
Hal Blanton, *At-Large, Lewis County*
Mary Beth Harrington, *Thurston County*
Dustin Loup, *Grays Harbor County*
Vacant Position, *Mason County*
Vacant Position, *At-Large, Thurston County*

Present Board: Toni Gwin, Brian Mittge, Hal Blanton, Mary Beth Harrington, Dustin Loup
Present Staff: Cheryl Heywood, Andrea Heisel, Brenda Lane, Rose Enos-Weedmark; recorder
Remote Access: Zoom: <https://Trl-org.zoom.us/j/82997086092> • Meeting ID: 829 9708 6092 • Phone Access (253) 215-8782 • Approximate Attendance = 17

Timberland Regional Library (TRL) Business Meeting Minutes

- 1. CALL TO ORDER AND ROLL CALL** – Toni Gwin called the meeting to order at 5:30 p.m.
- 2. PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE** – Brian Mittge led the pledge
- 3. LAND ACKNOWLEDGEMENT** – Toni Gwin read the acknowledgement statement
We respectfully acknowledge and honor the people, past, present, and future on whose ancestral lands we live, learn and work.
- 4. CORRESPONDENCE – at 2:42 of the recording** Cheryl shares an email dated November 19th from Jodilyn Ottobre regarding book placement. On November 6th from Julianne Gale, Executive Director of the Mason County Climate Justice titled “TRL gratitude stories.”
- 5. PUBLIC COMMENTS** – None
- 6. APPROVAL OF AGENDA AND CONSENT AGENDA ITEMS – at 3:31 of the recording**

25-033 – HAL BLANTON MADE A MOTION TO APPROVE THE AGENDA AND CONSENT AGENDA AS PRESENTED. MARY BETH HARRINGTON SECONDED. MOTION APPROVED (Unanimous 4).

- 7. EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR HIGHLIGHTS – at 4:39 of the recording** Cheryl shares:
 - Kristi S., Youth Services Coordinator, who has been with TRL for 37 years, will be leaving us and we thank her for all her years of service. Eileen, Lead Collection Service Specialist, will be retiring this year and we thank her as well for her years of service.
 - Leadership training is currently underway prioritizing supervisor training.
 - Brenda McGuigan, Anywhere Coordinating Librarian, coordinated and hosted the Outreach of Washington Library Systems (OWLS) at the Administrative Service Center in October. OWLS attendee survey stated that it was the best meeting to date, thank you Brenda.
 - Thank you, Creative Services staff, for creating the new children’s play spaces landing page on the TRL website. Thank you, Chris C., Public Information Officer, for his work on the landing pages for TRL History and Budget and Funding pages. Thank you to staff for creating blogs and e-newsletters with additional content shared out in a variety of ways.
 - Ocean Park refresh is on time and scheduled for a grand re-opening on January 10, 2026, from 12:00 to 2:00 p.m. The Lacey Library refresh of the bathrooms is scheduled for November 24th.
 - Washington Workforce Association (WWA) 2025 Chair Award Recipient, Cheryl Heywood. The YouTube video of this award has been shared with multiple agencies across the district.

Discussion of Executive Director Highlights – at 10:17 the recording Trustee Harrington commends Cheryl and the staff for the TRL partnerships and collaborations with other organizations.

8. FINANCIAL STATEMENTS & HIGHLIGHTS – at 12:00 of the recording Cheryl highlights the month ending October 31, 2025:

- **General Fund** - \$5,775,075.27 in property taxes was received; Timber revenue - \$20,765.33 was received; and \$539,082.70 in books and materials was purchased.
- **Technology Fund** – Had minimal activity.
- **Unemployment Fund** – Had minimal activity.
- **Gift Fund** – Had minimal activity.
- **Building Fund** – Payment of \$12,162.55 to Doors Unlimited was processed for automatic doors and bolts at the Ocean Park location.

9. COMMITTEE REPORTS

Budget Committee - Harrington/Gwin at 13:00 of the recording

A. 2026 Preliminary Budget – currently the estimated property tax revenue is \$27,100, 000, which is an increase of \$900,000 or 3.4%. We anticipate the timber revenue to begin shrinking and the rate has been adjusted, however state and county timber revenues have been strong. Good investment growth, third year in a row. Total estimated revenue of \$29,002,000, accounting for 93.7% of revenue coming from property taxes and 5.4% from timber, and 0.8% from other sources (all estimates are rounded).

B. Future Agenda Item Requests - None

Discussion of the Budget Committee Report – at 20:13 the recording Trustee Mittge asks about the TRL reserves trending downward and why that may be. Paige shares that our policy states that our beginning fund balance should equal 30% of the years expenditures, from the General Fund, until we get the influx of funding during the months of April, May, October, and November. Paige explains a future budget adjustment for increased funding of the Unemployment Fund.

25-034 – BRIAN MITTGE MOTIONS TO APPROVE THE 2026 PRELIMINARY BUDGET AS PRESENTED. HAL BLANTON SECONDED (Unanimous 5).

10. FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS – None

11. BOARD HOUSEKEEPING – at 39:25 of the recording Trustee Gwin reminds the Board of online trainings due. Gwin mentions the upcoming Facilities Committee meeting on December 2nd and the Regular Board Meeting at the Administrative Service Center in Tumwater December 17th. Cheryl mentions the Policy Committee meeting just before the Regular Board meeting on the 17th. Gwin also mentions the Friday Trustee Check-in with Cheryl where Gwin and Mittge will be attending.

12. EXECUTIVE SESSION pursuant to RCW 42.30.110 (d) and (g)

A. To review the negotiations of the Collective Bargaining Agreement (CBA) (d) – at 41:47 of the recording the Board of Trustees, Cheryl Heywood, and Brenda Lane go into executive session at 6:12 p.m. for 15 minutes. At 6:27 they return to regular session.

B. To review the performance of a public employee (g) – at 42:27 of the recording the Board of Trustees and Cheryl Heywood go into executive session at 6:28 p.m. for 15 minutes. At 6:43 p.m. the Board requests an additional 15 minutes. At 6:59 p.m. they return to regular session.

13. FINAL BOARD COMMENTS – at 43:31 of the recording Trustee Mittge comments on the printing service at TRL and how it is appreciated and thanks Paige for her work. Trustee Blanton states

that, “Libraries are open, we’re serving our patrons, and we’re doing a pretty good job...” Trustee Gwin shares her recent visit to the Raymond library.

14. ADJOURNMENT at 7:01 p.m.